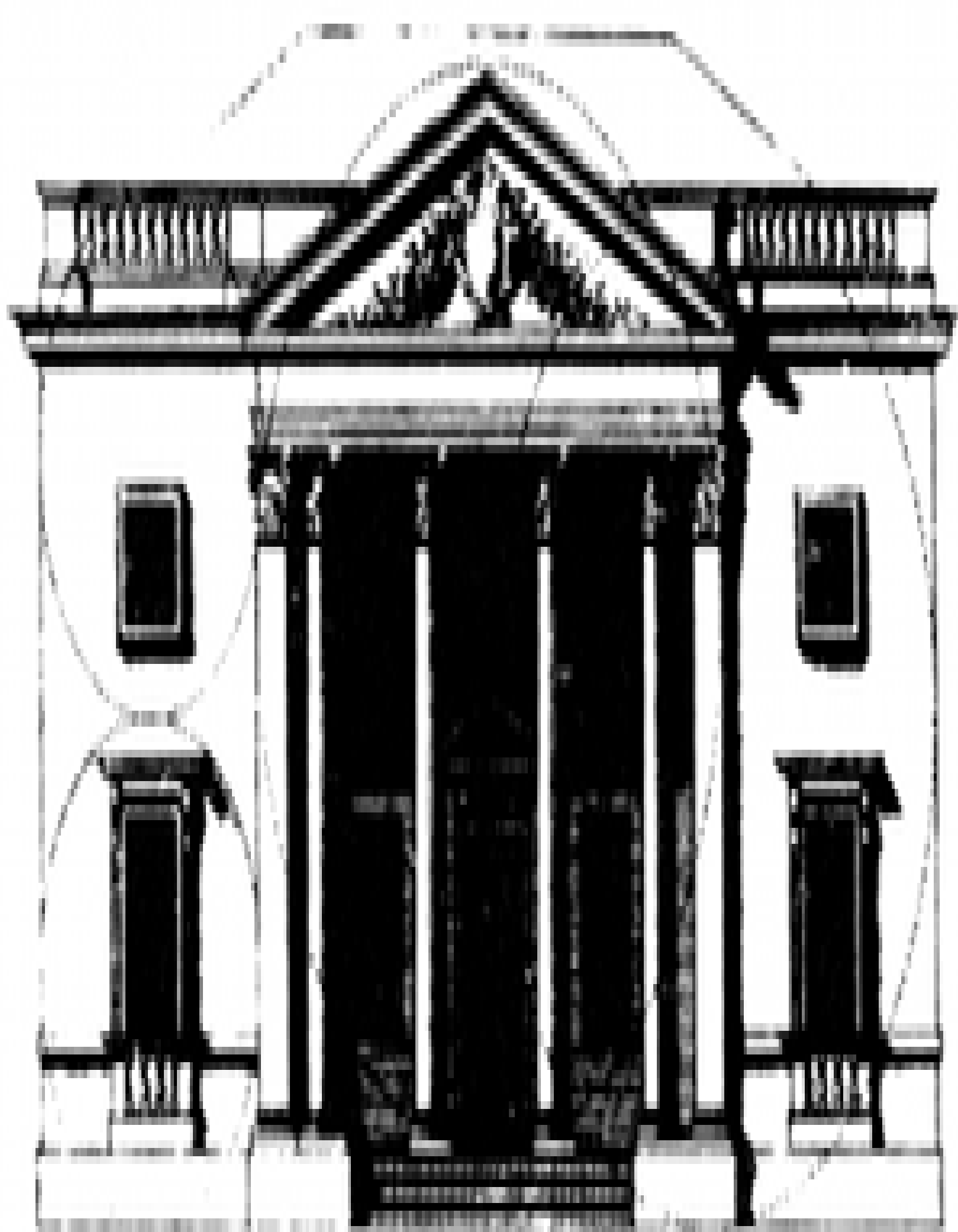






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ARCHITECTURE: A POEM IN IMITATION OF HORACE'S ART OF POETRY

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# THE Art of Architecture

A  
POEM

In Imitation of Horace's ART OF POETRY

(Anonymous)

(1742)

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*Introduction by*  
WILLIAM A. GIBSON

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## INTRODUCTION

John Gwynn, generally accepted as the author of *The Art of Architecture* (1742), is best known to students of English literature as one of the founders of the Royal Academy and as a friend of Samuel Johnson, who undertook in 1759 to win the Blackfriars Bridge commission for Gwynn with a series of three letters in the *Daily Gazeteer*<sup>1</sup>. To architectural historians Gwynn is best known as the architect whose proposals for regularizing the street plans of London and Westminster (in *London and Westminster Improved*, 1766) were prophetic both of the plan which eventually emerged from the land speculation and building boom of the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries and of the prominence subsequently given to city-planning.<sup>2</sup> But like Dr. Johnson, Gwynn looked as much to the past as he anticipated the future. This is almost inevitable since he too spans the years which saw the last expressions of humanist principles of art and the first struggles to find new bases for aesthetic judgments. Although the date of Gwynn's birth is unknown, he must have been almost an exact contemporary of Dr. Johnson, for he also began his literary career in the 1730's, gained public recognition in the 1750's, associated with members of the Literary Club in the 1760's, and died slightly over a year after Johnson, probably on 27 February 1786.

Their careers exhibit two more instructive parallels. Both began as amateurs, possessed of no specific training, and ended as self-supporting "professionals," able to exercise their skills on demand and fully conscious of the qualifications needed for membership within their professions.<sup>3</sup> Second, both began with the hope of "fixing" the rules of their arts, but ended by disavowing the intention or by implicitly contradicting it. Johnson records his disillusionment with one such attempt in the "Preface" to his *Dictionary* (1755). Gwynn's continuing interest in the attempt is evident in his early proposals for establishing an art academy (*An Essay on Design*, 1749) and in his serving as a representative of the architectural profession in the founding of the Royal Academy. However his efforts late in his career to accommodate his early principles to the needs of a nation in the midst of an economic and a building boom reveal a considerable shift from his dogmatic support of the rules of art in *The Art of Architecture*.

The poem is significant in a number of ways. It is the work of a young, inexperienced architect, with literary ambitions, who has learned most of what he knows about the principles of his art from published sources—treatises, pattern books, and measured drawings—rather than in an architect's studio or in a master mason's stone-cutting yard. Take, for example, one of his lists of architects worthy

of study: "With M—s, F—ft, G—s, L—i, W—e,/ Let ADMIRALTY, or CUSTOM-HOUSE compare" (p. 18). Four of these architects published treatises or translations of treatises which Gwynn certainly knew: Robert Morris, *Lectures on Architecture*, 1734-36<sup>4</sup>; James Gibbs, *Rules for Drawing the Several Parts of Architecture*, 1733; James Leoni, translations of Palladio, 1715-16, and of Alberti, 1726; Isaac Ware, translation of Palladio, 1737. The other architect referred to is Henry Flitcroft. The poem is, secondly, an unusually clear expression of the architectural principles—and dilemmas—of a man who is sensitive to changes in taste and in artistic practice, but unaware of the causes of the changes, and probably incapable of grasping their significance. This is precisely what makes *The Art of Architecture* a valuable document in the history of eighteenth-century criticism. The poem provides a brief but rather full summary of the major precepts of humanist architectural theory accepted in the first half of the century, and introduces an important English innovation. At the same time it reveals the passionate desperation of a man confident in his rules of art but powerless to impose them upon a society enamored of novelty. Gwynn never gave up his youthful ambition of improving English building, but he did give up the positiveness evident in this poem.

Gwynn's general critical bias is readily identifiable because it is consistent with that of many conventionally trained architects of the 1720's and 1730's, and with that of most propagandists for English Palladianism. Like the Earl of Burlington, William Kent, Colin Campbell, Morris, Ware, and Alexander Pope, Gwynn venerated Inigo Jones as England's Palladio, as the architect who showed how Palladio's rules could be naturalized for the English climate (pp. 14, 25). Similarly orthodox is his opinion of the fanciful baroque architecture of Sir John Vanbrugh and Nicholas Hawksmoor, both of whom are held up as perpetrators of tasteless, licentious innovation (pp. 14, 26). The more chaste baroque architects—Sir Christopher Wren, Gibbs, and Thomas Archer—Gwynn generally admires, although he recognizes occasional flaws in the works of Gibbs and Archer (pp. 14, 29). In remarking on his other "villain" architects, Gwynn reveals his political preferences and some acquaintance with current scandals. At least two of them were aligned with the court party. Thomas Ripley, a one-time carpenter who was one of Pope's targets of satire, erected Houghton for Robert Walpole in accordance with designs by Campbell (pp. 15, 17).<sup>5</sup> Edward Oakley dedicated his *Magazine of Architecture, Perspective and Sculpture* (1730) to Walpole, but received no posts such as those which Ripley, Hawksmoor, Vanbrugh, or John James enjoyed under the Walpole administration (p. 28). Two more architects whom he mentions, besides Gibbs, Vanbrugh, and Ripley, were employed on the notorious projects of the Duke of Chandos—John James and Andrew Shepherd (pp. 10, 23).<sup>6</sup> Gwynn's taste and principles were those of an educated elite to which he did not belong—conventional in their moral and aesthetic implications, and conservative in their political ones.

But the significance of *The Art of Architecture* is not merely as evidence of contemporary attitudes toward Hawksmoor or James, Chapman or Banks. It is rather what Gwynn believes they indicate: the failure to establish in England a building practice firmly based upon a body of principles which architects and men of letters in the first half of the eighteenth century had wanted to believe inviolable. The Palladian revival had helped to subvert the medieval crafts tradition in building (which had been vigorous through the seventeenth century) and had contributed to substituting for the pomp and flamboyance of the baroque a taste for regularity in outline, clear relationship of parts, and a relative simplicity of surface and ornament. Accompanying it was an unprecedented deluge of publications, all of which helped to create a greater popular consciousness of humanist architectural principles than had previously existed. Yet the revival was proving ineffectual, and perhaps the clearest evidence is in Gwynn's attack on Kent: "See the old GOTHs, in K——'s Designs survive;/ And Modern FOOLS, to imitate his strive" (p. 26). Kent edited the drawings of the English Palladio for the Earl of Burlington (*The Designs of Inigo Jones, With Some Additional Designs*, 1727); but at Esher Place, Surrey (ca. 1730), and again in Merlin's Cave, erected at Richmond Park for Queen Caroline (1735), he "anticipate[d] by twenty years the rococo Gothic of the 1750's."<sup>2</sup> The latter design was even published with some by Jones two years after *The Art of Architecture* in John Vardy's *Some Designs of Mr. Inigo Jones and Mr. William Kent* (1744). Clearly Vitruvius's rule of *decor* had not restrained even the publicists of Palladianism.

Humanist architectural theory was losing its authority even as it was being widely disseminated; it was also, as was only half clear to Gwynn, becoming increasingly unintelligible. Wealthy patrons of the art looked more and more upon exact knowledge of it as unbefitting the learning of a gentleman. Archaeological studies of antiquities, instead of helping to fix the rules of proportion, were contributing to aesthetic relativity by demonstrating the disparity between ancient practice and Vitruvius's rules. Claude Perrault attempted to resolve these disparities by a system of mathematical averages, but the result of his empirical method is only to substitute one source of relativity for another.<sup>8</sup> By the 1740's what Rudolf Wittkower has called the "break-away from the laws of harmonic proportion"<sup>9</sup> was well under way, and it represented but a part of the collapse of the several systems of arithmetic and geometric proportion which had dominated humanist theory. Developments in the history of thought made this collapse inevitable. The old aesthetics were based upon correspondences between divine and human artifacts. Thus in designing a building the architect emulated the Divine Architect who "ordered all things in measure and number and weight" (Wisdom 11:20). The geometric forms and the systems of mathematical and harmonic proportions of a building answered to those of the cosmos; likewise the aesthetic attributes of the cosmos—with their attendant moral ones—such as symmetry, uniformity, regularity, and fitness had their correspondences in architecture. Such assumptions provided immutable bases for



the rules external to the individual work of art, but the breakdown of analogical reasoning in the seventeenth and eighteenth centuries necessarily undermined such philosophical-theological foundations. The new epistemology, further, shifted attention from the external world—the previous source of the rules—to the mind perceiving it.

By the 1740's consciousness was growing of threats against the ethical and aesthetic values of Renaissance humanism (best expressed in Pope's *Dunciad in Four Books*), and of the consequent need for new sources of authority for the rules of art. One highly eccentric quest for authority was published just a year before *The Art of Architecture*: John Wood's *The Origins of Building*; or, *The Plagiarism of the Heathens Detected* (1741). Wood reconstructs the history of architecture to make it conform to Old Testament chronology. Thus he attributes the major tenets of Vitruvius's architectural theory to various patriarchs and ancient Jewish heroes, or, when he finds any justification for doing so, directly to God. Gwynn's attempt to buttress the rules is far more mundane. He seeks support from contemporary philosophy; for example, he introduces the epistemological and ethical systems of Shaftesbury to account for some principles of decorum, but without perceiving the subjectivity he was imposing on them. He rationalizes some of Vitruvius's analogies between natural and architectural forms. But even more clearly indicative of the futility of his effort are his appeals to authority. He implores such aristocratic patrons as Pembroke, Chesterfield, and Burlington to "Be to my *Muse* a Friend; assist my Cause;/Be Friend to *Science*, fix'd on *Nature's* Laws" (p. 30). Perhaps most important, however, is the authority of Horace himself, who provides the model for the poem.

Although neoclassical critics generally accepted the reality of correspondences between architectural and literary criticism, Gwynn did not find the *Ars Poetica* an entirely manageable model.<sup>10</sup> Horace's figures of the mad painter and the mad poet which frame the poem at either end serve Gwynn well, for his imitations of them as the mad painter and the mad architect emphasize the personal, social, and artistic consequences of attempting to build without rules, talent, or even a clear need to build. But within the poem, allusions to Horace are often much more elusive. He usually succeeds best in keeping close to Horace when citing the most general principles. Thus Horace's attack on bombast and timidity ("professus grandia turget;/serpit humi tutus nimium timidusque procellae," 11. 27-28) occasions an attack on misunderstood magnificence and on stodginess:

Others affect *Magnificence* alone;  
And rise in large enormous Heaps of Stone;  
Swell the huge *Dome*, and *Turrets* bid to rise,

And Towers on Towers; attract the Gazer's Eyes.  
Some dare not leave the old, the beaten Way,  
To search new Methods, or in Science stray ...

(p. 8.)

Similarly clear are Gwynn's adaptations of such commonplaces as the need to subordinate parts to the whole (p. 8) or for consistency of style (p. 15). Again, Horace asks whether a good poem is the product of nature or art—of native talent or of training—and denies that either is adequate alone (11. 408-418). Gwynn raises the same question about the architect, although in the first person, and answers,

If *Art*, or *Nature*, form'd me what I am;  
If one or both, assisted in the Plan,  
It is beyond, my utmost Power to say:  
Whether I *Art*, or *Nature*'s Laws obey.

(p. 31.)

Since such ambivalence as this is not appropriate to his purpose, he, unlike Horace, begins almost immediately to stress a course of study that will result in mastery of the rules.

This last rhetorical tactic points to one serious problem which Horace poses for Gwynn—that of assuming an appropriate stance for defending the rules. The tone of Horace's epistle to the Pisos is familiar without being condescending. He writes as an experienced poet and critic to fellow writers, delivering his pronouncements freely and confidently, but without dogmatism. Gwynn is neither an equal writing to equals nor an experienced architect, confident of his qualifications to instruct the world. At one moment he acknowledges the "Judgment's Height" of the addressee (p. 28), the next he holds himself up as possessing a skill worthy of emulation, and proceeds to deliver a lesson in the tone of a schoolmaster: "Those Things which seem of little Consequence,/ And slight and trivial ..." (p. 32). Horace's wit, his reliance upon his audience to grasp the implications of his many examples, and his avoidance of positiveness subvert Gwynn's purpose, as he reveals frequently in contradictory outbursts and in shifts in tone. Yet in one important passage Horace provides him with a stance and a theme which help him prop up the rules. After discussing pardonable faults (11. 347-365) Horace addresses Piso's elder son, compliments him for his wisdom and training, and *reminds him* of the activities in which mediocrity may be tolerated. This serves as a contrast to poetry: "*mediocribus*

esse poetis/ non homines, non di, non concessere columnae" (11. 372-373). For once Horace is almost uncompromising enough for Gwynn's purposes. He adopts a similarly magisterial tone, but reorders Horace's materials so that the emphasis is more fully on this principle:

But yet, *my Lord*, this *one* important Truth,  
This Law of *Science*, which we teach our Youth  
Even *THIS*, no Mediocrity admit,  
*Rules, Nature, Reason, all* must jointly fit:  
A *Painter* may RAPHAEL'S Judgment want,  
And yet, we some Abilities will grant: ...

In *BUILDING*, there's no *Laws* of human Kind,  
Admit a *Medium*; to the Artist's Mind,  
*All* must be perfect, or 'tis understood,  
Excessive *Ill*,——or else sublimely *Good*.

(pp. 29-30.)

Especially significant here is his insistence that the "Law of *Science*" will "no Mediocrity admit," for Horace discusses poetic practice rather than the rules which aid it. Secondly, the belabored inference drawn from the principle in the final couplet has no precedent at all in Horace. Gwynn has made every effort to place the rules outside the realm of human eccentricity and to give them the stature of "*Nature's Laws*."

Considering that the tenets of humanist architectural theory are traditionally classified very differently from those of literary criticism, as Gwynn acknowledges in his "Preface" (p. iii), he manages to accommodate them surprisingly well to the organization of the *Ars Poetica*. A good example is his treatment of Horace's discussion of the transitoriness of language, as of all things, and the necessary dominance of the rules of usage (11. 46-72). The most obvious parallel is the inevitable ruin of the pompous buildings which men erect (p. 11). But he develops none of the botanical analogies which Horace used to illustrate the rhythms of life and death (11. 60-69), for his purpose is to emphasize instead the parallel between *usus* and the architectural concept of "use." Horace insists, "*multa renascentur quae iam cecidere, cadentque/ quae nunc sunt in honore vocabula, si volet usus*" (11. 70-71). Gwynn elaborates on this:

But Use has rais'd the *Greek* and *Roman* Rules,  
And banish'd *GOTHICK* Practice from the Schools.  
Use is the Judge, the Law, the Rule of Things,  
Whence *ARTS* arose, and whence the *SCIENCE* springs.

(p. 11)[11](#)

Horace and Gwynn both think of "use" operating as a kind of historical necessity causing the resurrection of a rule or a form. Gwynn adds to this the concept, drawn from Vitruvius and his commentators, that the rules of architecture prescribe forms which satisfy particular uses and reflect directly the strengths and limitations of building materials and techniques. These are the major premises of Gwynn's assertion that "on *Nature's* perfect Plan,/ I form my *SYSTEM*" (p. 31). To buttress this confidence in rules he develops the parallels between Horace's history of poetry (11. 73-98) and the history of architecture. Cecrops, the first king of Athens, is to architectural practice what Homer is to heroic poetry. Daedalus is to the theory of architecture what Archilochus is to the meter of dramatic poetry (pp. 11-12). The emphasis on the giving and systematizing of rules, although without precedent in Horace, reflects the same preoccupation with the authority of origins as John Wood's *Origins of Building*, Pope's *Essay on Criticism*, or even Locke's *Two Treatises on Government* for that matter.

Horace provides less precise correspondences for one of the most important rules. Vitruvius's rule of *decor* (*De Architectura*, I, ii, 5) is only generally parallel to the rules governing decorum of language, characterization, and genre. Gwynn nevertheless introduces all of its major implications. It dictates the observing of clear correspondences between a building's form and its use, inhabitant, and site (or "situation," to use the eighteenth-century term). It is based upon the notion that architectural styles have recognizable social, ethical, religious, and aesthetic attributes. The attributes, which evoke predictable psychological responses, express the *uses* which the styles were created to satisfy and the cultures in which they were developed. One brief passage beginning "If to adapt your Fabrick, you would choose,/ To suit the *Builder's* Genius, or his Use" (pp. 15-16) effectively summarizes the primary dictates of *decor*. The architect has to choose forms and ornaments having attributes in common with the social station and character traits of the builder of a residence,[12](#) with the deity to whom a temple is dedicated, with a building's function, or with the landscape in which it is placed. Thus, for example, the heavy, plain Tuscan order is appropriate for "A *little* Structure; built for Use alone," the "gaiety" of the middle Ionic order for a country villa, and the "delicacy" of the Corinthian order for an elegant church or palace (p. 25). An architect's skill is most often measured in the poem by his adherence to *decor*.

One violator of *decor* serves as a focus in an important passage wherein Gwynn tries to integrate Vitruvius and Horace while making a transition to one of his central concerns, the peculiarly English reinterpretation of decorum of situation. In discussing the difficulty of treating traditional subjects in novel ways, Horace compares an erring "scriptor cyclicus olim" with Homer, summarizes some general principles, and then turns to a consideration of how to win public applause (ll. 119-178). Gwynn is more suspicious of originality than Horace (p. 17), and uses Ripley as an example of one who erred in trying to avoid customary forms. Ripley's Custom House (1718) and Admiralty building (1723-26) become the equivalent of the Cyclic poet's bad verse, while Morris, Flitcroft, Gibbs, Leoni, and Ware become the modern Homers of architecture (p. 18). Gwynn ends the verse paragraph with Horace's theme of suiting the parts to the whole. With Ripley's performance as a background Gwynn turns to architecture's most fundamental rules:

CRITICKS, attend the Rules which I impart;  
They are at least; *instructive* to the Art:  
Mark how *Convenience*, *Strength*, and *Beauty* join:  
With these let *Harmony of Parts* combine.

(p. 18.)

These lines may be construed as the architect's equivalent of Horace's advice for winning applause. But in fact the entire verse paragraph which these lines introduce is simply a paraphrase of Vitruvius (I, iii, 2. Cf. Wotton's remark, "*Wel-building* hath three Conditions, *Commodity*, *Firmnesse*, and *Delight*").<sup>13</sup> The leap which follows the introduction of these three principles has no precedent in Horace, but it does in Vitruvius, whose *De Architectura* is notorious for its eccentric organization and abrupt transitions. Immediately following this passage in Vitruvius is his chapter on the "salubrity of sites" (I, iv).

It is ironical that where Gwynn is closest to Vitruvius in one respect he departs most radically from him in another. Vitruvius's attention is almost exclusively on the physical requirements of sites for maintaining men's health and comfort; Gwynn's is on the requirements for maintaining men's psychological well-being. His conceptions of decorum of situation begin with Vitruvius and the Renaissance demands that a site be healthy, that it permit efficient transportation, and that, if possible, it provide raw materials for building, rich lands for crops and pastures, and natural beauty conducive to ease and contemplation. Gwynn emphasizes this last point, building upon perceptions of nature nourished on Thomson's *Seasons*, and upon a psychology drawn largely from the Earl of Shaftesbury (pp. 19-22). In his earlier *Essay on Harmony. As it relates chiefly to Situation in Building* he quotes

Shaftesbury on the title page, acknowledges his debt to Thomson, and quotes long passages from *The Seasons* to illustrate various rural "situations."<sup>14</sup> In *The Art of Architecture* he follows Morris's example in writing his own verse in language imitative of Thomson's (except for one direct quotation, "From the *moist Meadow*; to the *brown-brow'd Hill*"). The verbal precision of his poetic epithets, and the analysis of perception which they imply, help to distinguish the sensory, aesthetic, and emotional effects of a wide variety of disparate experiences, and thus make possible the identification of those attributes that guide an architect in choosing a *mode* appropriate to a site. The perfect fitting of a building to its site, as of the parts to a whole, will result in what Gwynn calls "Ideal Harmony," for it "ariseth from such Numbers, Parts, or Proportions, which may be resolved in the Mind, and ranged together in Order, by Contemplation."<sup>15</sup>

For Gwynn such harmony still has quite clear religious and moral implications, although he does not, like Morris, attribute to it a specifically religious function. Yet since the rules are supposedly based upon natural laws, violations of them betray a failure to appreciate divine harmony, the highest object of human contemplation. This accounts for the indignation Gwynn reveals in attacking mad architects and patrons at the end of the poem, even if it also reveals his obtuseness in failing to perceive the causes of his outrage. But, then, Gwynn was no Alexander Pope, either as a poet or as a thinker.<sup>16</sup>

The Ohio State University

# NOTES TO THE INTRODUCTION

1. ([return](#))

Both James Boswell and Sir John Hawkins briefly discuss Johnson's relations with Gwynn in their biographies of Johnson. The fullest accounts of Gwynn's life and professional activities are those in the *DNB* and in H. M. Colvin, *Biographical Dictionary of English Architects, 1660-1830* (London, 1954), pp. 254-256. Both attribute the poem to him. I am much indebted throughout this introduction to Colvin for information on the architects mentioned in the poem.

2. ([return](#))

For an estimate of the significance of Gwynn's perceptions see chapter nine of John Summerson's *Georgian London*, rev. ed. (Harmondsworth, 1962). His perceptiveness was recognized by the early nineteenth century. Gregg International published a facsimile reprint of *London and Westminster Improved* in 1969.

3. ([return](#))

A work which shows Gwynn's awareness of the differences between the casual and perhaps well-read dilettante and the dedicated professional is his essay *The Qualifications and Duty of a Surveyor* (London, 1752). For discussions of the development of the architectural profession in eighteenth-century England, see Colvin, pp. 10-25, and, in spite of his excessively narrow definition of "profession," Barrington Kaye, *The Development of the Architectural Profession in Britain, A Sociological Study* (London, 1960), pp. 39-67.

4. ([return](#))

One indication of Gwynn's admiration for Robert Morris is the title page of *The Art of Architecture*. The elevation used as an ornament is not just modelled on a design by Morris; the plate used to print the elevation is the very plate, slightly reworked, which printed the design facing p. 209 in Morris's *Lectures*. Most of the original dimension lines have been obliterated, and the original pyramidal roof has been truncated.

5. ([return](#))

*Epistle to Burlington*, II. 17-18; *Imitations of Horace*, II, i, 185-186; *The Dunciad in Four Books*, III, 327-328.

6. ([return](#))

C. H. Collins and Muriel I. Baker, *The Life and Circumstances of James Brydges, First Duke of Chandos* (Oxford, 1949), pp. 115-120, 146, 300, 387-389.

7. ([return](#))

Colvin, p. 342.

8. ([return](#))

*A Treatise of the Five Orders of Columns in Architecture*, trans. by John James (London, 1708).

9. ([return](#))

Rudolf Wittkower, *Architectural Principles in the Age of Humanism*, 3rd ed. (London, 1962), p. 142. For a summary of England's part in this "break-away" see pp. 150-153.

10. ([return](#))

Parenthetical references to the *Ars Poetica* are to the Loeb edition, trans., H. Rushton Fairclough (Cambridge, Mass., 1929).

11. ([return](#))  
Cf. Pope, "You show us, Rome was glorious, not profuse,/ And pompous buildings once were things of Use" (*Epistle to Burlington*, 11. 23-24).
12. ([return](#))  
See Sir Henry Wotton, "Elements of Architecture" (1624), in *Reliquiae Wottonianae* (London, 1651), pp. 304-305.
13. ([return](#))  
Ibid., p. 201.
14. ([return](#))  
*Essay on Harmony* (London, 1739), pp. 27-31.
15. ([return](#))  
Ibid., p. 9.
16. ([return](#))  
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## BIBLIOGRAPHICAL NOTE

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is reproduced from a copy in the British Museum.

THE  
Art of Architecture,  
  
A  
POEM.

In Imitation of HORACE'S Art of POETRY.

Humbly Inscribed to the R<sup>t</sup>. Hon<sup>ble</sup> the Earl of ———

---

*Ingenuas didicisse fideliter artes,  
Emollit mores, nec finit esse feros.*

OVID.

LONDON:

Printed for R. DODSLEY, at TULLY's Head in *Pall-Mall*; and  
Sold by T. COOPER at the *Globe* in *Pater-noster-Row*, 1742.

[Price, One Shilling.]



## THE PREFACE.

*The great Freedom with which HORACE has been used, I hope will be in some Measure an Excuse for the Liberty I take in this Essay.—The Art of Cookery, and Harlequin-Horace are two glaring Instances, not to mention Numberless Translators, Commentators, &c. upon his Works; in which some have so Remark'd and Revis'd, that they have explain'd the Sense of Horace quite away.—I for my Part, either as a Poetical ARCHITECT, or an Architectural POET, profess myself to be only an humble IMITATOR of him: I have seldom lost sight of the Original, at least as far as the Subject will permit.—But ARCHITECTURE is a barren Theme, and a Path so beaten, that to step out of it, though purely to avoid the Crowd, is looked upon as an unpardonable Singularity. How far I may have strayed in this Poetical Excursion, I know not; but of this, I am certain I can with Truth say with HORACE,*

——*Si quid novisti rectius istis,  
Candidus imperti; si non, his Utere Mecum.*



# THE ART of ARCHITECTURE,

In Imitation of HORACE'S Art of POETRY.

Should you, my LORD, a wretched Picture view;  
Which some unskilful Copying-*Painter* drew,  
Without Design, Intolerably bad,  
Would you not smile, and think the Man was mad?  
Just so a tasteless Structure; where each Part  
Is void of *Order*, *Symmetry*, or *Art*:  
Alike offends, when we the Mimick Place;  
Compare with *Beauty*, *Harmony*, or *Grace*.

PAINTERS, and ARCHITECTS are not confin'd  
By *Pedant-Rules* to circumscribe the Mind:  
But give a Loose, their Genius to improve;  
And 'midst the pleasing Fields of *Science* rove.  
But then the Laws of *Nature*; and of Sense,  
Forbid us with Contraries to dispense:  
To *paint* a Snake, engend'ring with a Dove;  
Or *build* a Prison 'midst a shady Grove.

At setting out, some promise mighty Things,  
*Temples* they form, and *Palaces* for Kings;  
With a few *Ornaments* profusely drest,  
They shine through all the *Dulness* of the rest.  
At some long *Vista's* End, the Structure stands;  
The Spot a Summit, and a View commands:

The wide-extended Plain appears below,  
 And Streams, which through the verdant Meadows flow.  
 Here *Towns*, and *Spires*, and *Hills* o'er Hills extend;  
 There *shady Groves*, and *Lawns*, the Prospect end.  
 Through lavish *Ornaments*, the Fabrick shines  
 With wild Festoons of Fruits, and clust'ring Vines:  
 Luxuriant Decorations fill each Space,  
 And vast Incumbrances, void of *Rules* or *Grace*;  
 Without Coherence, crowded in each Place.

}

Should you require a little rising Pile,  
 The Parts appropriate to the fertile Soil:  
 Where *Neatness*, *Order*, and *Proportion* join;  
 Where *Strength*, and *Art*, and *Nature* should combine:  
 The mimic *Architect* perhaps would be  
 As much to seek in his Design; as HE  
 Whose only Talent was, to paint a *Tree*.  
 With such gay Structures, why do they begin  
 Such *Glare* of Ornament to usher in?  
 Why such external needless Dress and Show?  
 The End improprie, and the Meaning low.  
 Form to each *Clime*, each *Place*, a *Modus* still;  
 But use the same Proportions at your Will.  
 Change, modify your Form: Transpose, divide;  
 The same unerring Rules the *Science* guide.

}

Most ARCHITECTS in something do offend,  
 When led by, aim'd-at-Excellence; to mend—  
 By striving to be plain, they sometimes fall,  
 So *Mean*, so *Dull*, so *Tasteless*: they spoil all.  
 Others affect *Magnificence* alone;  
 And rise in large enormous Heaps of Stone;  
 Swell the huge *Dome*, and *Turrets* bid to rise,  
 And Towers on Towers; attract the Gazer's Eyes.

Some dare not leave the old, the beaten Way,  
To search new Methods, or in Science stray:  
Others with wild Varieties engage,  
And build a Seat to face the *Ocean's* Rage;  
Carve *Fruit* and *Flowers*, to face the raging Floods,  
Festoons of Shells, or Fish, for shady Woods.  
Thus willful Erring, join'd with Want of Skill,  
Is the most certain Way of Erring still.

The meanest Workman, may attempt to place  
A little Dress to decorate a Space;  
May put an Ornament about a Door,  
Or decorate a Window, and no more:  
But then to *finish*, is beyond his Skill,  
And we suppose the rest, exceeding ill.  
And 'tis ridiculous for one good Part,  
Where what remains are Scandal to the Art;  
Where only one is luckily adorn'd,  
And all the rest remarkably deform'd.

Let *Architects* attempt their Skill to show  
In *small* Designs at first; in what they know.  
Then as they find their Genius rise, to try  
How much their Structures they can magnify.  
Shew how *Convenience*, *Beauty*, *Symmetry*,  
How *Method*, *Art*, and *Nature* will agree.  
Rules well appropriate will ever please,  
And proper Dress, is plac'd with greatest Ease.  
First study *Nature*, where, and how to fill  
The various Voids, and ornament with Skill.  
Chuse the *just* Emblems for the Pile and Spot;  
The Dress of *Temples* suit not with a *Grot*.  
The *Palace*, and the *Villa* differ wide,  
For both, a proper Ornament provide,

Perhaps in *this*, you must Profuseness spare;  
When *that*; requires you to be lavish there.

If from the usual Taste your Building springs  
Magnificently great, a Seat for Kings,  
Let your exalted Fancy, tho' 'tis new,  
Keep the great Arts of *Greece* and *Rome* in View;  
From thence your Fabrick form, your Genius flow,  
Thence bid the *Ravish'd Gazer's* Bosom glow.  
Can an impartial Critick justly blame  
A Fault in JONES, (or FL-T-FT, is the same;)   
And yet approve in HAWKSMOOR, or in J——s,  
The same wild Error, or the same Extremes?  
Why should the few, the Rules which I impart,  
Be construed ill, be Scandal to the Art?  
When GIBBS, so copious, so enrich'd has been,  
No Part's obscure, but all are useful seen.

Men always had, and ever will, Pretence,  
At least with Method, to improve our Sense:  
And the last Laws, however just or true,  
Must give the Palm to such which are more new.  
One Year, a Train of Images arise,  
The next a gayer, newer Form supplies.  
One Scene improv'd, must to another yield,  
And all resign to FATE, and quit the Field.

The fam'd St. HELLEN's, and the fam'd TORBAY,  
Where GEORGE's GLORIOUS FLEETS, in *Safety* lay.  
The *Bank*, the *Meuse*, the *Treasury* will fall,  
One common Ruin overwhelming all:  
Nay this great CITY may be lost in Flames,  
And what are *Villa's*, may be desert *Plains*.  
The *Bleating Flocks*, on ruin'd *Fabricks* stray,  
And what were *Temples*, now in *Ashes* lay:

The *Groves* arise where *Gilded Turrets* shone,  
And what are *Gardens* now, were Heaps of *Stone*.  
Yet THOSE, and THEY, will in Oblivion lye,  
And all, in future Times, forgot, and die.  
Why then should *Artists* challenge future Praise,  
When Time devours their Works so many Ways?  
But Use has rais'd the *Greek* and *Roman* Rules,  
And banish'd GOTHICK Practice from the Schools.  
Use is the Judge, the Law, the Rule of Things,  
Whence ARTS arose, and whence the SCIENCE springs.

At ATHENS first the rising Art began;  
CECROPS, the King, first modell'd out the Plan.  
The studious Youth; pursued with ardent Care  
The Infant Rules, unpolish'd as they were,  
Till banish'd DÆDALUS Protection sought,  
*There* well receiv'd, the stricter Rules he taught;  
Their *Arts*, their *Sciences*, were learn'd in Schools,  
And all their *Precepts* were confin'd to Rules.

The swelling *Tree*, as it unpolish'd grew  
Undecorated, *Native* Graces shew;  
From thence the COLUMN, in its purer Dress,  
The Work of *Nature*, must the Form confess:  
The *wreath'd*, the *fluted*, or th' *encumb'ring* Vine,  
With plenteous *Branches* round the Pillar twine;  
Yet still its pure Simplicity you see;  
The Shaft of *Art*, resembles still a *Tree*.

But how to appropriate, to embellish still  
Justly, the Space to decorate and fill,  
To give proportion'd Beauty to each Part,  
To make the whole subservient to the Art:  
The Inborn-Traces of the Mind pursue,  
For Nature teaches how to find the Clue.



The *silent Groves* a little Pile must grace;  
Nor yet too grave, or lavish for the Place.  
We find the middle Path, the Way to please,  
And decorate the Parts with greater Ease.  
But when the Opening to some distant Scene,  
Where *Lawns*, and *liv'ning Prospects* intervene;  
Where *Vista's* or delightful *Gardens* charm;  
Where *verdant Beauties* all our Senses warm:  
Let *Flow'rs* and *Fruit* in seeming Wildness grow;  
And there let lavish *Nature* seem to flow.  
*There* let the Parts, the Gazer's Eye surprize;  
And with the *Glebe* the *Structure* HARMONIZE.  
Where *Severn*, *Trent*, or *Thames's* ouzy *Side*,  
Pours the smooth Current of their easy Tide:  
Each will require a Sameness to the Spot,  
For this a *Cell*, a *Cascade*, or a *Grott*.  
The *Moss*, or *gliding Streams* productive Store,  
To grace the *Building* on the *verdant Shore*:  
There the rough *Tuscan*, or the *Rustick* fix,  
Or *Pebbles*, *Shells*, or calcin'd *Matter* mix.  
The *frozen Isicle's* resembled Form,  
Or *Sea-green Weed*, your GROTTO must adorn.

Near some *lone Wood*, the *gay Pavilion* place;  
Let the CORINTHIAN MODE the Structure grace:  
Carve here *Festoons* of lovely Flowers and Fruit:  
And with the Spot, let the *Enrichments* suit.  
On some Ascent, the plainer Fabrick view;  
The Dress IONICK, and the SCULPTURES few.  
Few are the Ornaments, but plain and neat,  
The *least* REDUNDANT are the *most* COMPLEAT.  
GIBBS may be said, most Times in Dress to please,  
And few can decorate with greater Ease:  
But JONES more justly knew the Eye to charm,

To please the Judgment, and the Fancy warm;  
To give a Greatness to the *opening Glade*,  
Or pleasing Softness to the *solemn Shade*;  
To suit the *Valley*, or the rising *Hill*,  
Or grace the *Flow'ry Mead*, or *Silver Rill*.

In *H—k—r*; *V—b—*'s very Soul you trace,  
The same *unmeaning* Dress, in every Place;  
The same *wild Heap* of inconsistent Things:  
From whence the PRISON, or the Palace springs;  
A *Tuscan Portal* for a *Palace Gate*,  
And a *Corinthian Column* in a LAKE.  
For disproportion'd Columns *R—l—*s see,  
Where neither *Art*, or *Rules*, or Form agree;  
Absurdly bad, and grown a publick Jest:  
By far too HIGH—too HEAVY all the rest.

Would you the Sister-Arts improve in Schools?  
In *Sculpture* follow RYSBRACK's chosen Rules;  
In *Portrait* seek for AMICONI's Force:  
*Humour* in HOGARTH: WOOTEN for a *Horse*:  
In *Landscape*, LAMBERT; or in *Crayons*, see  
The Charms of *Colours* flowing from GOUPEE.  
In *Eloquence*, you see young MURRAY shine;  
In *Musick*, HANDEL's Graces are divine.

If to adapt your Fabrick, you would choose  
To suit the *Builder's* Genius, or his Use:  
Consider well his *Station*, *Birth*, or *Parts*,  
And make for each the *Quintessence* of Arts.  
Here to the MUSE, a proper Part assign,  
To BACCHUS there, direct the *golden Vine*;  
To VENUS, fix a little *silent Cell*,  
Where all the LOVES and GRACES choose to dwell:  
Where the young *Wantons*, revel, sport, and play;

And *frisk* and *frollick* tedious Time away.  
The PRISON's Entrance, *massy Chains* declare,  
The loss of Freedom, to the Wretched there.  
Thus every Spot assumes a various Face;  
And *Decoration* varies with the Place.  
The TUSCAN or the DORIAN Modus here;  
Th' IONICK, or CORINTHIAN Modus there.

The *Temples, Baths*, or solemn *sacred Urn*,  
Requires Attention, and our Skill in turn.  
The *weeping Statue* to the HERO lend;  
True to his *Country, Family, or Friend*:  
So place the Figure, that as you draw near,  
You join his Grief, and drop a silent Tear.  
So *fine*, so *just*, the *Attitude* is made,  
The faithful *Marble* bids you mourn his Shade.  
If you advent'rous, try your utmost Skill  
To tread unbeaten Paths, be *Lofty* still;  
Keep up the *Strength*, the *Dignity*, and *Force*  
Of *stated Rules*; let those direct your Course.  
New Methods are not easy understood;  
And few will step in an untrodden Road.  
'Tis better to pursue the Rule that's known,  
Than trust to an Invention of your own.  
But then, be sure your Choice direct you right;  
Vary, but keep the Original in sight:  
The Orders just proportion; strict observe,  
The Variation; various Uses serve.  
Perhaps the Waste, which every Pile endures,  
May make the Copy, justly pass for yours.  
You need not slavish Imitators be,  
Exact in Copy; but your Fancy free:  
THIS Ornament omit, or THERE express  
The changing Modus, by a different Dress.

R——y, in *Rustick* heavy Buildings still,  
Attempts in vain to please, or shew his Skill;  
How far he strays from the pure *Roman* Stile,  
And labours on in DULNESS all the while!  
With M—s, F—ft, G—s, L—i, W—e,  
Let ADMIRALTY, or CUSTOM-HOUSE compare.  
You'll see the wretched Structure's sinking State,  
Blam'd to Futurity, their certain Fate.  
He with a Glare of Gaiety extends  
The lengthen'd PILE, and still with DULNESS ends:  
But THOSE without your Expectation rise;  
And dazzle the Beholder with Surprise.  
Nothing is vain, or ill-expos'd to sight;  
No Part too *heavy*, nor no Dress too *light*.  
So certain are the Methods they have fix'd,  
So just proportion'd, and so aptly mix'd,  
That all seem Graceful, Uniform, and Neat;  
Each Part is *perfect*, and the *Whole* compleat.

CRITICKS, attend the Rules which I impart;  
They are at least; *instructive* to the Art:  
Mark how *Convenience*, *Strength*, and *Beauty* join:  
With these let *Harmony of Parts* combine.  
Appropriate well the *Structure* to the Place;  
And give each Part a *Symmetry* and *Grace*.  
Make RULES your Guide, your Fancy to controul;  
And make *each* Part subservient to the Whole.

But choice of Place must be the BUILDER's Care,  
For various *Climates*, various *Modes* prepare.  
To some a *pleasing Vale*; (the Poet's Song)  
Where *silver Streams* in Eddies glide along;  
A little rising Hill, with Woods o'ergrown,  
And at the Foot, a verdant Carpet thrown:

Where the soft *vernal Bloom* beneath is spread;  
Where the tall *Poplar* hangs its *drooping Head*.  
Where, on the Bank, the *Flowers* and *Oziers* green,  
Shade the smooth *Current* as it runs between;  
The *fertile Meads*, enamell'd all around,  
And the *rich Glebe* with *yellow Harvest* crown'd.

Others in long-extended Views delight,  
Where *gilded Objects* catch the Gazer's Sight.  
Where the *wide Plain*, or *lawny Prospect* lye,  
In mingled Sweets, to chear the *ravish'd Eye*.  
Where the VALE, winding round the *rising Hill*;  
The LILLY drinks beneath; the latent RILL.  
The *Lawns*, the *silver Streams*, the *opening Glade*,  
The distant *solemn Grove's* collected Shade:  
Charms of the *verdant*, or the *flow'ry Plain*;  
The rising *Mountain*, or the distant *Main*.——  
Where *rugged Rocks*, in wild Disorder rise;  
Where *unprolifick Nature*, naked lies;  
Where the vast *craggy Summit* seems to shew,  
A *falling Precipice* to those below:  
Expos'd to scorching Heats, or piercing Wind,  
May more delight another's changing Mind;  
Or the rude *Billows* of tempestuous Seas,  
Another's Eye, perhaps, may chance to please:  
View on the Summit of a foaming Wave,  
The unhappy *Sailor* try's himself to save;  
The floating Wreck, the Vessel's shatter'd Side,  
Dash'd on the Shore, by the resistless Tide:  
The foaming *Surge* the Shore repells again;  
And beats alternate, back upon the Main:  
View the abandon'd, helpless Wretch's State;  
Sinking, bemoans his LAST unhappy Fate.

All these the ARCHITECT must study well;  
From the proud *Palace* to the humble *Cell*.  
The barren *Mountain*, and the rural *Shade*;  
The mingled gay Profusion, Nature made,  
To fit and tally, Art requires his Skill,  
From the *moist Meadow*; to the *brown-brow'd Hill*,  
The silent *shady Grove*, or *silver Rill*.  
To give a Grandeur to the *Opening Lawn*;  
And pleasing Softness, to the *solemn Dawn*;  
To join the *vivid*, with the *vernal Bloom*;  
Where scarce a Sun Beam wanders thro' the Gloom.  
This is the Art's Perfection well to know;  
To charm the Sense, and bid the Bosom glow:  
Teach us to imitate the ANCIENTS well;  
And where the *Moderns* we should still *excell*.

}

Make the *Pavilion* proper for the Spot,  
Or the *gay Temple*, or the *graver Grot*.  
Adorn your *Villa* with the nicest Art,  
And let your Dress, be just in every Part;  
Appropriate well, the Ornaments you choose;  
But not alone for Gaiety; but Use.

In a warm Climate where the *Tyber* flows;  
Where in the Soil, the obdurate *Marble* grows,  
There on the Spot, make choice of what you will,  
But HERE to use it, would be want of Skill:  
And 'tis an equal Fault of those alone;  
Who vainly imitate a *Portland-Stone*,  
The dryer Climates, cherish *Stucco* there,  
But Rains, and colder Snows, destroy it here.  
Avoid, as much as in you lyes, to place,  
*Festoons*, or looser Ornament for Grace:  
Few let the *Carvings* be; for outside Dress:

A Boldness rather should your Thoughts express,  
Redundancy, and Neatness will be lost:  
And but to finish HIGH; is needless Cost.  
But then, regard to Distance must be had:  
If near the Eye, the Fault would be as bad.

S——D, in Spite of Reason and of Sense,  
With all those Faults, and Follies will dispense;  
*Carv'd Fronts*, and STUCCO decorated still,  
Without Regard to place, the Fabrick fill:  
'Tis meant perhaps some *Fracture* to conceal,  
Though frequent so; the more it does reveal:  
Such are the Reasons, should our Practice sway,  
And where the strongest plead, we should obey,  
The *most* demonstrative, the *safest* are;  
And what are not, we should avoid with Care:  
As you'd fly SCYLLA, or CHARYBDIS shun,  
Or Tricks of SCAPIN, HARLEQUIN, or LUN.

*Convenience* first, then *Beauty* is a Part,  
And *Strength* must be Assistant to the Art.  
A *little* Seat, a Neatness will require:  
A PALACE claims a more majestick Fire,  
*That* made for Decency; for Grandeur *this*,  
And even Profuseness, may be not amiss.  
*Here* a long vista'd Chain of Rooms of State,  
To entertain the Attendants on the Great,  
The glittering Dress, to *catch* the Gazer's Sight,  
At once to give Surprise; and to delight.

The GREEKS to three, confined the stated Rules,  
And only *those*, were known in public Schools;  
Till Rome the *Tuscan*, and *Composite* join'd,  
To enrich the Art, and to improve Mankind,  
From these alone, all *Modes*, all ORDERS spring

To build a *Cell*, or *Palace* for a KING.

First the grave DORICK Mode; for Use was form'd,  
When in its Infant-State, and unadorn'd:  
'Twas Entertainment for the *sager* Few,  
And pleas'd the Times, till something started new:  
Then the gay, *Lydian Mode*; in Order rose,  
And Art to Art, they wantonly oppose:  
For Men grew fickle by Prosperity,  
Study'd new Arts, and Ease and Luxury.  
At length the rich CORINTHIAN's gayer Dress  
The Artist's Decorations, well express.

The GOTHS first introduc'd the frantick Way  
Of forming Apes, or *Monsters*, wild as they  
Because the Tumult, fond of Tricks and Apes,  
Lov'd such Variety, and antick Shapes.  
But K——T has no Excuse, to copy these,  
Unless he has; NO other Way to please.

The *Modern* Artists, all their Genius show  
In a *Venetian-Window*, or a Bow.  
The *Cell*, the *Temple*, *Palace*, *Villa*, all  
Must have a Window, they *Venetian* call,  
Or Bow; to grace a *Grotto*, or a *Hall*.

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A *little* Structure; built for Use alone,  
Requires no Dress, nor Ornament of Stone:  
The *Plainest*, *Neatest*, Method is the best:  
One simple Modus, governs all the rest.  
The *Villa* next with Ornament you blend;  
The *gay* and *pleasing* through the whole extend;  
The TEMPLE, or the GAYER-PALACE will,  
In Decoration, try your utmost Skill.  
Learn of PALLADIO, how to deck a Space;



Of JONES you'll learn Magnificence, and Grace:  
CAMPBELL will teach, the Beauty they impart;  
And GIBBS, the Rules and Modus of the Art:  
Keep still these Rules, and Methods, in your Sight;  
Read them by Day, and meditate by Night.

But V—B—H was admir'd, in *Anna's* Days,  
And even his *Blenheim*, would excite some Praise.  
And H—S—R travell'd in the same *dull* Road,  
And trod the Footsteps, which his *Master* trod:  
But BOYLE and PEMBROKE, have the Art restor'd;  
And *distant* Ages will their Fame record.

See the old GOTHS, in K——'s Designs survive;  
And Modern FOOLS, to imitate his strive:  
Renouncing all the *Rules* the ROMANS had,  
Are past reclaiming, obstinately mad.  
Drunken N—C-A, with a Front direct,  
Or stupid B——s, makes such an Architect;  
Unhappy I!——But *Fortune* stept between:  
And proper *Physick* cur'd me of the Spleen.  
And now I'm satisfy'd to keep my Sense:  
Make RULES my Guide, to plead in my Defence:  
Give to the *Roman Sciences* their Due:  
And *write*, to whet that Appetite, in you.  
Tell what the Duty of a BUILDER is,  
Point out what's *Right* in Practice; what's amiss.  
Shew *where*, and *how* to decorate with Skill,  
What *Ornaments* are just, and what are ill.  
Shew how the *Judgment*, should conduct the Art,  
And where *Judiciousness*, directs the Part;  
Where proper *Situation* claims our Care;  
Where RULES should guide; and where most *useful* are.

The ARCHITECT, all Ranks of Men should know,

And when, and where, to bid his Genius flow  
To swell the *Rules*, for MAJESTY, and State,  
To equal all the Grandeur of the Great;  
To serve the Use of SENATORS, or KINGS,  
And be the Source, from whence all *Science* springs.

Sometimes in *old* Designs, you *Grandeur* view,  
And even in *Negligence*, find something new.  
But modern Youth are taught to *sing*, and *dance*,  
And learn the FOLLIES, and the *Modes* of *France*;  
Neglecting *Method*, *Order*, *Time*, or *Sense*,  
With all their JARGON, and their *Modes* dispense.  
They make the *Dorick*, and *Corinthian* mix;  
And with th' *Ionian*, the *Composite* fix.  
The *Grave* and *Gay*, in one long Range extend;  
And with the *Solemn*, the *Profusive* blend.  
Can Structures, built by such a *Builder*, live?  
Will A—f—y, think you; C—p—n survive?  
Will O—k—y, B—s, and some whom I could name?  
Whose Works already; DAMN them into Fame.  
Will they, or *not*, all Rules, all Modes deface.  
Invert all ORDER, and the Art *disgrace*?  
Will B—f—w; M—d—n; FOOLS by Nature made  
Will they encrease, or will they ruin Trade?

'Tis you, MY LORD, who know your Judgment's Height,  
Your Precepts, and Instructions, are of Weight;  
Clear, and succinct, the *lower Class* to teach,  
And oft, above the *towering* Artists Reach;  
Where the gay Ornament you please to place,  
And where it gives a *Majesty* and Grace.  
These are the *Rules*, will live in *future* Days,  
The Youth's Director, and the *Poet's Lays*,  
'Tis these will shine when in Oblivion lay'd:

The GOTHs forgotten, and the MODERNS dead.

The skillful Archer, may his Aim mistake;  
And the best Hand in Musick, Jarring make:  
So that, the Frailty of our Nature will,  
Excuse as Accident, nor construe ill.  
But if the Impertinent, their *Faults* are told,  
And *still* persist; and *still*, their Follies hold:  
Let them *abandon'd*, *senseless*, *stupid* be,  
And, past reclaiming, still be DULL for me.

In some great Structures, *Lowness* is exprest;  
And SLEEP even sometimes, HOMER lull'd to Rest;  
*Building*, like *Painting*, proper Point of Sight,  
Requires to view it, in its clearest Light;  
And some tho' aim'd at *Grandeur*; or at Ease,  
Even please but *once*, and some will EVER please.

But yet, *my Lord*, this *one* important Truth,  
This Law of *Science*, which we teach our Youth,  
Even THIS, no Mediocrity admit,  
*Rules*, *Nature*, *Reason*, all must jointly fit:  
A *Painter* may RAPHAEL's Judgment want,  
And yet, we some Abilities will grant:  
He may, perhaps, a skillful Painter be,  
Tho' not so great, yet great in some Degree.  
In BUILDING, there's no *Laws* of human Kind,  
Admit a *Medium*; to the Artist's Mind,  
*All* must be perfect, or 'tis understood,  
Excessive *Ill*,—or else sublimely *Good*.  
In Things where Reason, seems but to subside,  
Men learn to stem, the Torrent of the *Tide*;  
They *dance*, or *fence*, or vainly wish to *fly*,  
But if they fail, contented cease to try.

But all in BUILDING, universal run,  
Undoing others, and themselves undone.

Oh B——LE! or S——N——PE, P——M-KE; any Name,  
That ARTS, or VIRTUE; raises into Fame,  
Be to my *Muse* a Friend; assist my Cause;  
Be Friend to *Science*, fix'd on *Nature's* Laws.  
On that alone, on *Nature's* perfect Plan,  
I form my SYSTEM, as I FIRST began.  
By YOU inspir'd, I boldly lay the Line,  
And ev'n am vain to call the Subject mine.  
So ORPHEUS, once by more than human Sway,  
Tam'd *savage Beasts*, or Men as wild as they;  
And when AMPHION, built the THEBAN WALL,  
The Stones, by Magick Power, obey'd his Call.  
So *Ancient*, even in EGYPT's pristine State,  
Recorded ARCHITECTURE, has its Date.

Since thus, my Lord; what GODS and KINGS inspire,  
*What* bids my Bosom glow with *arduous* Fire;  
This *Noble Art*, disdain not to protect;  
If not the Art, at least the ARCHITECT.  
If *Art*, or *Nature*, form'd me what I am;  
If one or both, assisted in the Plan,  
It is beyond, my utmost Power to say:  
Whether I *Art*, or *Nature's* Laws obey.  
Without each other, we in vain should strive;  
To BUILD, or keep the SCIENCES alive;  
*Each* mutually assist, and *each* will need,  
The other's Help, as NATURE has decreed.

He that intends an *Architect* to be,  
Must seriously deliberate, like me;  
Must see the *Situation, Mode* and *Form*,

Of every *Structure*, which they would adorn:  
All Parts *External*, and *Internal*, view;  
Before they aim to raise, a something new.

Ask *G*—s, or *F*—*tc*—*t*, to correct your Plan,  
They'll freely, where you err, instruct the Man,  
In what's amiss, with Judgment, and with Care,  
Where needful *add*; and where profusive; *spare*.  
But if you selfish; foolishly defend;  
Your glaring Faults, and will not strive to mend,  
To his own Folly——leave the Wretch alone,  
And without Rival, let him BLUNDER on.

Those Things which seem of little Consequence,  
And slight and trivial; know; you some time hence,  
When you are made ridiculous; will find,  
They are important, and instruct the Mind:  
If in a *Building Fit*, a FRANTIC Man:  
Should *wildly* scheme, a bad, or monstrous Plan,  
Not minding *where*, or *how*, or *what*, to lay,  
For a Foundation, or his *Workmen* pay:  
If he should find, a Prison for his Pains,  
(Misfortune justly suited to his Brains)  
No one would *pity*, or *condole* his Fate,  
But think he merited, the *Bedlam-State*.

EMPEDOCLES, with Madness sought the Flame,  
And thought by that; to gain immortal *Fame*.  
Let ARCHITECTS, and BUILDERS, *mad* as they,  
In Folly; run, and make themselves away;  
Why should it be a *Sin*, such Men to kill,  
More than to keep alive, against their Will?  
It was not *Chance*, but *Choice*, the Poet made,  
To seek *Divinity*, in LETHE's Shade;  
For if he was, from PLUTO's *Sable Plain*,

Return'd to *Earth*,——He'd *ÆTNA* seek again.

'Tis hard to say, whether the *Gloomy Clime*,  
Or *Murder*, *Incest*, or some heinous Crime,  
Sends *Building-Fiends*, into the *Madding World*,  
Govern'd by *Frenzy*; by Confusion *hurl'd*,  
Seize all they meet; and——like the baited BEAR,  
Without Distinction, *Range*, and *Rend*, and *Tear*:  
No one escapes them: from Lord O—R—D: down,  
To B——s, and every errant Fool in Town:  
They *build*, or teach; are leading, or are led;  
And never cease, till they're in Jail, or dead.

*FINIS.*



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